

PROGRAMMING IN JAVA-EVALUATED PROJECT

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EXPENSE TRACKER

1. Introduction

The Expense Tracker is a simple Java-based command-line application created to help users keep track of their daily expenses. The main idea behind the project is to provide an easy way to record spending details and keep them organized in one place. The application stores the expense information in a CSV file, making the data simple to access and manage.

2. Objective

The main objective of this project is to develop a simple and practical application for managing personal expenses. It allows users to record details such as the date, category, description, and amount spent. The application also helps users calculate their total expenses, understand their spending based on categories, and search for particular expense records.

3. Technologies Used

The project is completely developed using **Java** and works through the command line. A CSV file is used for storing the expense records. The program uses standard Java libraries for taking user input, handling files, processing dates, and managing the stored data. No external libraries are required to run the application.

4. Features

The application provides different options to make expense management simple. Users can add a new expense by entering the required details and can view all the expenses that have already been recorded. The application can also calculate the total amount spent and provide a category-wise summary. A search option is included to help users find expenses based on their category or description.

5. Working of the Project

When the application starts, a menu is displayed in the terminal. The user can select an option by entering the corresponding number. When a new expense is added, the details are saved in the expenses.csv file. Whenever the user wants to view or analyze the expenses, the program reads

the stored data from the CSV file and processes it accordingly. If the CSV file is not available, the program automatically creates it with the required headings.

6. Project Structure

The project contains a Java source file named `ExpenseTracker.java`, which contains the main application and all the required operations. The `expenses.csv` file is used to store the expense records. The **README.md** file provides information about the project and explains how to set it up and run it. The `requirements.txt` file is included for repository completeness, although the project does not require any external dependencies.

7. Execution

The project is designed to run completely through the command line without requiring a graphical interface. The Java program can first be compiled using `javac ExpenseTracker.java` and then executed using `java Expense Tracker`. Once the application starts, the user can select the required option from the menu and manage their expenses.

8. Conclusion

The Expense Tracker is a small and practical Java project that can be used to maintain everyday expense records. While developing this project, concepts such as classes, methods, user input, file handling, collections, exception handling, and CSV data processing are used. The project provides a simple way to understand how basic Java programming concepts can be combined to create a useful real-world application.